Interval Quality

The interval number counts letter names. The **interval quality** counts half steps, and tells apart intervals with the same number. C to E and C to E♭ are both 3rds, but C to E spans four half steps and C to E♭ spans three.

Intervals above the tonic

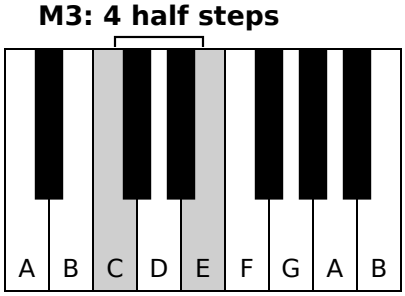
In a major scale, every interval from the tonic up to another scale note is either **perfect** or **major**. The unison, 4th, 5th, and octave are perfect (P). The 2nd, 3rd, 6th, and 7th are major (M).

A quick test: if the upper note belongs to the major scale that starts on the lower note, the interval is major or perfect.

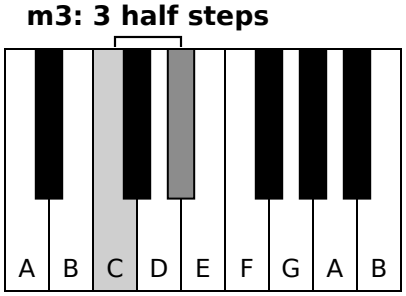
Interval	Half steps	Example	Quality	Symbol
unison	0	C–C	perfect	**P1**
2nd	2	C–D	major 2nd	**M2**
3rd	4	C–E	major 3rd	**M3**
4th	5	C–F	perfect 4th	**P4**
5th	7	C–G	perfect 5th	**P5**
6th	9	C–A	major 6th	**M6**
7th	11	C–B	major 7th	**M7**
octave	12	C–C	perfect	**P8**

Minor intervals

A **minor** interval (m) is one half step smaller than a major interval with the same number. Lower the upper note of a major 3rd by a half step, and it becomes a minor 3rd. A half step is a minor 2nd: E to F and B to C are minor 2nds.



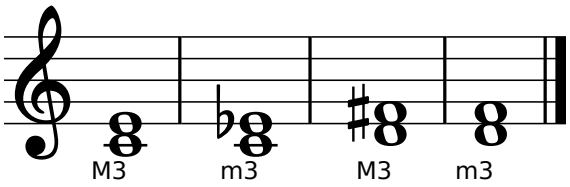
C to E: major 3rd



C to E♭: minor 3rd

Naming an interval

1. Count the letter names to find the number.
2. Count the half steps on the keyboard, or check whether the upper note is in the major scale of the lower note.
3. Write the quality and number together: M3, m3, P5.



This chapter uses perfect and major intervals, the minor 3rd, and the minor 2nd.

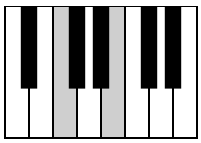
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Name _____ Date _____

Interval Quality

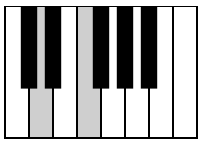
A. Count the half steps Write the number of half steps between the two shaded keys.

EXAMPLE

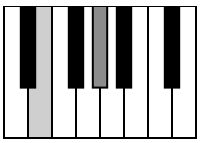


4

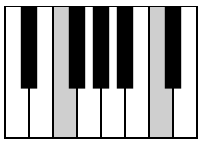
1.



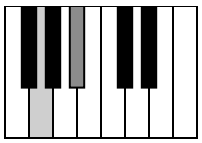
2.



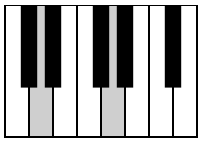
3.



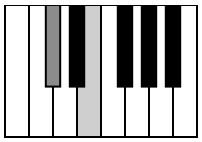
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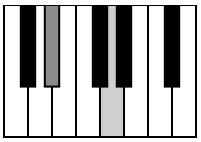
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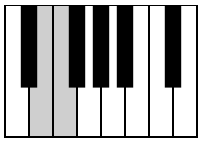
6.



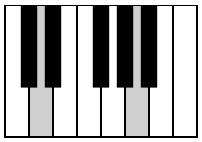
7.



8.

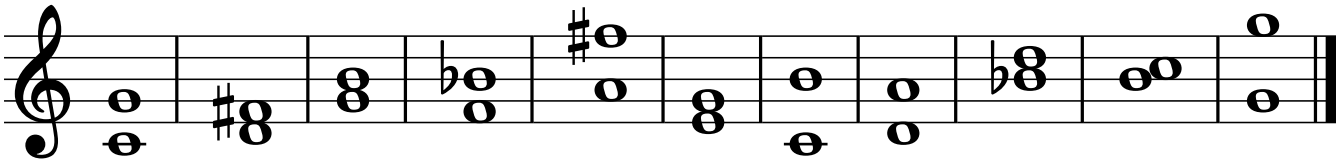


9.



B. Name the interval Write the quality and number of each interval: P, M, or m, followed by the number.

EXAMPLE 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10.



P5 _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

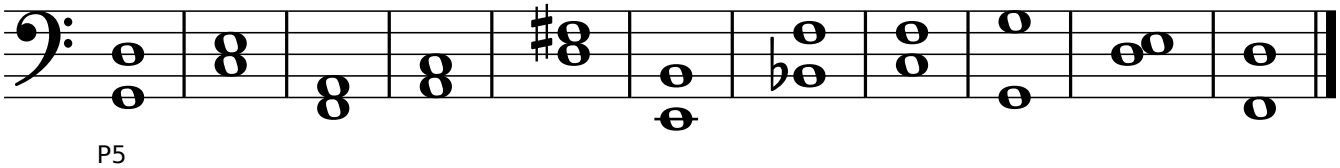
C. Major or minor 3rd Write M3 or m3 for each 3rd.

EXAMPLE C to E: M3

1. D to F: _____
2. E to G: _____
3. F to A: _____
4. G to B: _____
5. A to C: _____
6. G to B♭: _____
7. D to F♯: _____
8. B to D: _____
9. E♭ to G: _____
10. A to C♯: _____
11. E to G♯: _____

D. Intervals in the bass clef Write the quality and number of each interval.

EXAMPLE 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10.



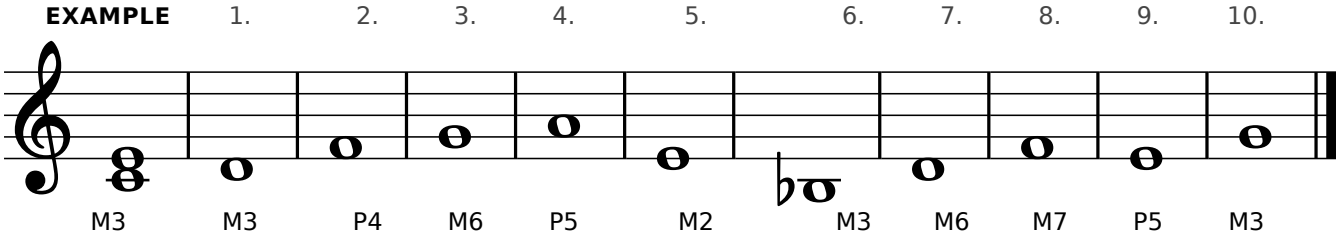
P5 _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

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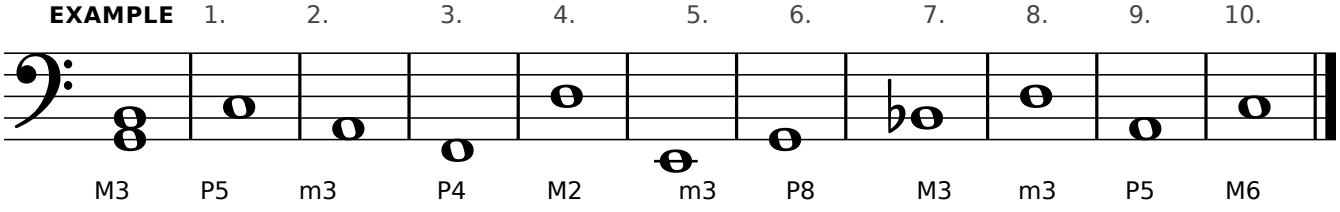
Name _____ Date _____

Writing Intervals by Quality

A. Major and perfect intervals Write the note that makes each interval. Add a sharp or flat where the interval needs one.



B. Intervals in the bass clef Write the note that makes each interval.



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